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- The error has to be reported before end of the month that is mentioned on cover of the magazine
- The report has to be sent in writing or by email addressed to the Editor, EFY Magazine (editsec@efyindia.com)
- The error should be of factual nature, in the information published in the magazine, and not a grammatical or syntax error
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of new-age consumers, a few projectors even support HDMI, Wi-Fi and iPod/iPad connectors.

Pico projectors are USB-friendly

Aping smartphones, some projectors support USB connection only, which provides dual compatibility for both data and power. Usually, such models have no internal battery. These are often called the 'USB projectors.' These serve just like pico projectors, connectivity being the only difference.

Technologies used

Pico projectors have LEDs as light source, which implies these projectors have a long useful life due to efficient use of battery power. In most models, display technology is either DLP or LCoS.

Overall, there are four distinct technologies powering these portable projectors:

1. LCoS (liquid crystal on silicon).

It uses a small LCD panel to filter light from an LED source. Together with DLP, this is the most popular technology these days.

2. DLP (digital light processing).

It comprises tiny mirrors on a chip to direct light from an LED source. It is used by many companies including Optoma, LG and Samsung.

3. Laser-LCoS. It is the same as

LCoS filter, with laser light source being the only difference.

4. Laser-beam-steering. Being the

latest one, there are only a few products available with this technology. It uses lasers and a single tiny mirror

A speckle is a sort of interference produced by random-intensity patterns occurring out of a set of wavefronts. In a general sense, it implies to shiny metallic dots visible all over the image

Make sure you accompany your pico projector with a miniature tripod, which is essential to adjust your image height and stabilise the projector in a hands-free environment

(some models use two) to direct the light. The image is created one 'pixel' at a time. Lasers are bright, efficient and always in focus, but suffer from Speckle effect. A speckle is a sort of interference produced by random-intensity patterns occurring out of a set of wavefronts. In a general sense, it implies to shiny metallic dots visible all over the image.

Cabling requirements

Pico projectors come with the convenience of reduced space requirements. It is not that tough to find a good place for them to project where you want to. But when you add those entangled cables from another gadget, these projectors might give you a headache. Some projectors support internal memory and/or memory cards, so they can play content without the need for another device. Some can play videos and images, while others also support office documents.

Battery life

Majority of these projectors can run for about an hour on their rechargeable battery. This run time limit can actually play spoilsport in watching full-length movies. So look out for models that offer external batteries. You can buy these batteries along with the projector.

Weight

Pico projectors usually weigh 150 to 250 grams. Moving up the price ladder, some projectors are really light at around 85 grams, but these do not include a battery and must be powered using a USB cable. ●

The author was a tech correspondent at EFY